UNIT 1 PROFILING ONESELF FOR THE JOB

Structure

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1.0 OBJECTIVES

In this unit, which is the introductory unit for the block, you will learn

- about the qualities necessary at the workplace
- how to behave when you go to a new office/work place
- how to write a profile of another person using clues/hints given
- to read a profile of a successful person and understand the qualities required
- vocabulary related to personal/social/professional qualities/business
- to understand language structures required for asking and answering questions related to the workplace.

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1.1 WARM UP

Look at these sentences from a conversation between two friends looking for a job:

Salman: "You know, final year of college is almost getting over, and I am so confused about life. I don't know what kind of job I want. What about you?"

Amir: "I know that I want a job with a decent salary."

Salman: "But you must be having some job objectives?"

Amir: "My objectives are very simple. I want security of service and an opportunity to do well in life."

Salman: "But everyone tells me one should have long-term as well as short-term goals. Have you thought about that?"

Now, enact a Role-play. One of you takes the role of Salman, and the other plays Amir. You may add more lines.

1.2 READING COMPREHENSION: A PROFILE

You must have heard of William (Bill) H. Gates, Chairman of Microsoft Corporation, who is among the world's richest people. Read his profile and answer the questions that follow.

William (Bill) H. Gates is the principal founder of Microsoft Corporation, the worldwide leader in software, services and solutions, that help people and businesses realize their full potential. Microsoft had revenues of US$ 39.79 billion for the fiscal year ending June 2005, and employs more than 61,000 people in 102 countries and regions.

On June 15, 2006, Microsoft announced that effective July 2008 Gates will move out of a day-to-day role in the company and spend more time on his global health and education work at the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation. After July 2008, Gates served as Microsoft's Chairman till February 2014. Subsequently he took on the post of Technology Advisor to support the newly appointed CEO Satya Nadella.

Born on Oct. 28, 1955, Gates grew up in Seattle with his two sisters. Their father, William H. Gates II, is a Seattle attorney. Their late mother, Mary Gates, was a schoolteacher, University of Washington Regent, and Chairwoman of United Way International.

Gates attended a public elementary school and the private Lakeside School. There, he discovered his interest in software and began programming computers at the young age of 13.

In 1973, Gates entered Harvard University as a freshman. While at Harvard, Gates developed a version of the programming language BASIC for the first microcomputer – the MITS Altair.

In his junior year, Gates left Harvard to devote his energies to Microsoft, a company he had begun in 1975 with his childhood friend Paul Allen. Guided by a belief that the computer would be a valuable tool on every office desktop and in every home, they began developing software for personal computers. Gates' foresight and his vision for personal computing have been central to the success of Microsoft and the software industry.

Under Gates' leadership, Microsoft's mission has been to continually advance and improve software technology, and to make it easier, more cost-effective and more enjoyable for people to use computers. The company is committed to a long-term view, reflected in its investment of approximately $6.2 billion on research and development in the 2005 fiscal year.

In 1999, Gates wrote *Business @ the Speed of Thought,* a book that shows how computer technology can solve business problems in fundamentally new ways. The book was published in 25 languages and is available in more than 60 countries. *Business @* the *Speed of Thought* has received wide critical acclaim, and was listed on the best-seller lists of the New *York Times*, *USA Today, the Wall Street Journal and Amazon.com*. Gates' previous book, *The Road Ahead,* published in 1995, held the No. 1 spot on the *New York Times'* bestseller list for seven weeks.

Gates has donated the proceeds of the book to non-profit organizations that support the use of technology in education and skills development.

In addition to this love of computers and software, Gates founded Corbis, which is developing one of the world's largest resources of visual information – a comprehensive digital archive of art and photography from public and private collections around the globe.

Philanthropy is also important to Gates. He and his wife, Melinda, have endowed a foundation with more than $28.8 billion (as of January 2005) to support philanthropic initiatives in the areas of global health and learning, with the hope that in the 21st century, advances in these critical areas will be available for all people.

Gates was married on Jan. 1, 1994, to Melinda French Gates. They have three children. Gates is an avid reader, and enjoys playing golf and bridge. (from the Internet last updated June 2006)

Activity 1

1) i) Who is William (Bill) Gates?

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ii) What is Microsoft Corporation?

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iii) Why did Gates start Microsoft Corporation?

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iv) What is the Mission of Microsoft?

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v) Besides being interested in Computers, what are the two other things Gates is known for?

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vi) What are the things Gates likes to do in his leisure time?

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2) Complete the following sentences.

i) Bill Gates was born…….

ii) He started showing interest in ……..when……..

iii) Gates went to Harvard University ……and while studying at Harvard, Gates …….

iv) In 1975, Gates started……..

v) In 1999 he wrote …… The book tells the reader……..

vi) In 1994, Gates married ……. and they have ……

1.3 VOCABULARY : PERSONAL, SOCIAL AND PROFESSIONAL QUALITIES

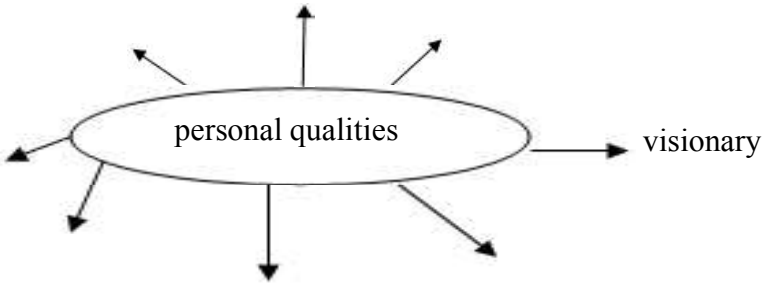
Talking about people, the business world, and computers

Activity 2

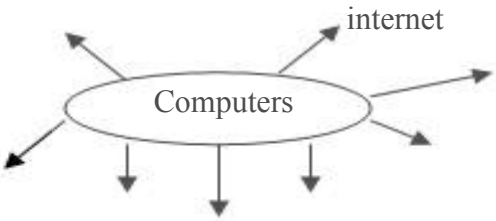
1) Look at the following jumbled words which are taken from the profile of Bill Gates. Put them in their appropriate webs. Add more words of your own.

leadership, revenue, software programming, internet, access, visionary, BASIC, fiscal year, philanthropic, chairperson, organization, foresight, cost effective, personal computer, language, Microsoft, global company

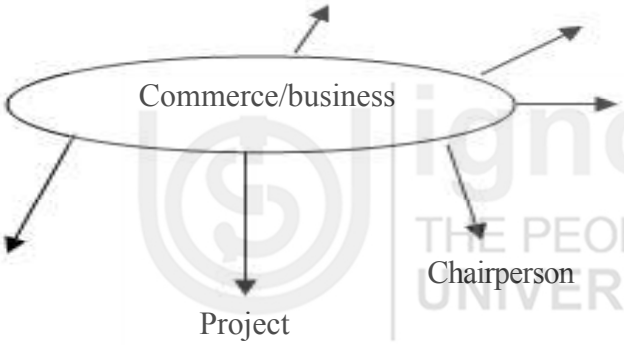
a)



b)



c)



2) In order to be successful at the workplace you need personal, social and professional qualities. You will find words related to these qualities in the box given below. Put the words in their appropriate lists. You will find that some words fit into more than one list.

team leader	motivator	leadership
soft spoken	open minded	conflict resolution
disciplined	receptive to new ideas	ability to empathize
friendly	helpful	approachable
hardworking	persuasive	dedicated
creative	firm	able to meet deadlines
punctual	role model	inspiring others

Personal	**Social**	**Professional**
hardworking	friendly	leadership
.....	.....	.....
.....	.....	.....
.....	.....	.....

3) From the list above, say which three qualities from each list are important at the workplace. Why are they important according to you?

a) ....

b) ....

c) ....

1.4 LISTENING: TALKING ABOUT ONESELF

Activity 3

Listen to World Tennis player from Hyderabad, India – Sania Mirza talk about herself. Listen again then answer the questions.



Photo credit: http://www.freepressjournal.in//its-been-an-amazing-year-for-me-sania-mirza/706873

i) Who is Sania Mirza?

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ii) What are some of her achievements?

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iii) What are three qualities of Sania that impress you?

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iv) What are Sania's interests and hobbies?

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v) Complete the following sentences

a) Sania's Coach allowed her to play when……..

b) She became the first woman to win a WTA title at the age of ……...

c) The secret of her the success is ……..

d) If she had not become a tennis player she would have ……..

e) Sania's dream is ……..

1.5 SPEAKING: GIVING A SELF PROFILE

You have first listened to Sania Mirza talk about herself. Now you have to give a brief self profile to people who do not know much about you.

Speak about yourself using the following hints.
(You may write down what you have to speak on a notepad first)

Hints

1) Give your full name, age, date of birth, etc.
2) Tell something about your educational background-schooling/college, etc).
3) Say what you wish to do in life.
4) Talk about a special achievement and how you managed to get success.
5) Describe some of your personality traits/qualities.
6) Talk about your hobbies/interests in life and any secret wish or desire you may have.

1.6 GRAMMAR: WH-QUESTIONS

At the work place you need to ask questions to know about people, their qualifications, interests, etc. You also need to answer questions correctly when you are asked about yourself, the department you work for, what work you do and so on. These are known as Wh - questions.

Another way of making questions is to reverse the word order of the subject and verb in a sentence as can be seen from the examples given below:

Statement

1) Bill Gates is the Chairman of Microsoft Corporation.

   Is Bill Gates the Chairman of Microsoft Corporation?

2) Bill Gates continued to be the Chairman of Microsoft Micro Corporation till February 2014.

   Did Bill Gates continue to be the Chairman of Microsoft Corporation till February 2014?

Another way of making a question sentence is by using *do*, *does* and *did* in front of the subject.

'Do, and, does' are used in the sentences with the simple present tense, and 'did' is used in the sentences with the simple past tense, as in the following sentences:

1) Plants grow quickly.	1) Do plants grow quickly?
2) The sun rises in the east.	2) Does the sun rise in the east?
3) Sandeep got up late yesterday.	3) Did Sandeep get up late yesterday?

Sentence 1 has been changed into a question by putting 'do' before the plural subject 'plants'. There is no change in the form of the verb 'grow'.

Sentence 2 has been changed into a question by putting 'does' before the singular subject 'Sun'. The ending -es in the verb 'rises' has been dropped from the verb. We use 'does' with *he, she, it* and all singular nouns in the subject position. Sentence 3 has been changed into a question by putting 'did' before the subject 'Sandeep'. The past tense form of the verb 'got up' has been changed into the simple present tense form of the verb 'get up'.

We use 'did' with all similar and plural subjects.

Activity 4

I) Write questions seeking information to the answers given, and answers to the questions asked.

Q1) Who is Roger Federer?

A) .....

Q2) .....

A) The office timings are from 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.

3) .....

A) Mr. Aziz Adani is the manager of the sales department.

Q4) In which department does Sunil Arora Work? (Hint: Purchase department)

A) .....

Q5) .....

A) She is Amia John.

Q6) .....

A) It is on the third floor. (Hint: Director's office)

Q7) .....

A) She is busy today. You can meet her only on Monday. (Hint: Principal)

II) Change the following sentences into questions:

1) Students work very hard near the exam.
2) All of them played their parts very well in the dance.
3) The Amazon is the largest river in the world.
4) A horse can run very fast.
5) The lion is the king of the forest.
6) Hitler hated Jews the most.
7) I sent my younger brother an email yesterday.
8) They work from morning till evening.
9) My father always helps my mother on Sundays.
10) The baby cried the whole night.

1.8 WRITING: A PROFILE

Writing 1

Activity 5

Write about any one person in your college/workplace: Use the questions to help you.

Who is s/he?

What is her/his educational background?

In which department does s/he work?

What work does s/he do?

What are her/his personal and professional qualities?

What makes her/him different from others?

What are her/his hobbies?

What are her/his future plans?

What are her/his achievements?

Use the notes given below to write about V. Narayana Murthy, Chairman, Infosys India.

Notes

- is an icon of new India
- is the greatest businessman of recent times
- creates a culture of discipline at the workplace
- creates wealth and shares wealth
- eye for perfection
- global citizen
- listens to others patiently
- respects all people
- believes in simplicity-lives in a 3 bedroom house



Chairman, Infosys, India
(Retired on 20th August 2006)

1.8 LET US SUM UP

In order to be successful at the workplace, you need to be prepared to speak and write about yourself. Introducing yourself with confidence; being well prepared to meet new people, meet new challenges, etc. will go a long way in enabling you to adjust to a new job.

In this unit you have learnt about personal, social and professional qualities needed at work.

You have read about some very successful people like Bill Gates, Sania Mirza, Narayan Murthy etc and what makes them successful.

You have also learnt how to talk about yourself and to write a self profile.

In the Grammar Section you have learnt how to frame questions and answer them.

1.9 ANSWERS

Activity 1

1) i) Chairperson of Microsoft Corporation and a philanthropist interested in learning and health issues.

   ii) Worldwide leader in software services and solutions.

   iii) He believed that the computer would be a valuable tool on every office desk and in every home.

   iv) To continually advance and improve software technology, and to make it easier, more cost effective and enjoyable for people to use the computer.

v) He founded Corbis, which is developing one of the world's largest resources of visual information which includes digital art and photography from public and private collections around the world. He is philanthropic and donates billions of dollars for global health and learning.

vi) Reading, playing golf and bridge

2) i) on October 28, 1955.

ii) computers ———— when he was 13 years old.

iii) in 1973 —— developed the programming language BASIC.

iv) a company called Microsoft

v) *Business @ the speed of thought* ———— how computer technology can solve business problems.

vi) Melinda —— 3 children.

Activity 2

1) Personal qualities - leadership, visionary, philanthropic, foresight,

Computers– software programming, internet, access, BASIC, personal computer, language, Microsoft

Commerce/business – revenue, fiscal year, organization, cost effective, global company, chairperson

2)

Personal	Social	Professional
Punctual	role model	team leader
Creative	friendly	approachable
Disciplined	team leader	able to meet deadlines
Soft spoken	approachable	punctual
Helpful	open-minded	conflict resolution
Firm	conflict resolution	inspiring others
Hardworking	ability to empathize	motivator
Dedicated	dedicated	

Tape Script

Hi! I'm Sania Mirza from Hyderabad, India. I was born on November 15th, 1986.

I am a tennis player and my dream is to win the Wimbledon Singles Championship one day.

I was introduced to tennis at the age of six but my coach refused to allow me to play when he saw me. When he saw my game, he was quite amazed!

I have reached the position at which I am today only because of my hard work and dedication, and the support of all my family members.

When I decide to do something, I leave no stone unturned to get success in it.

In February 2005, I became the first ever Indian woman to win a WTA title, by winning the AP Tourism Hyderabad Open, defeating ninth seeded Alona Bondarenko in the final.

Often, I sit back and reflect on my strengths and weaknesses. By doing so I am able to think of the strategies to overcome my weak areas.

I became the first female Indian to be seeded in a Grand Slam Event at the 2006 Australian Open.

In partnership with Martina Hingis we became one of the greatest doubles teams in women's tennis and won 14 titles in 16 months including three Grand Slam titles – Australian Open, Wimbledon and US Open and 41 matches from 2015 to 2016.

Besides playing tennis, I enjoy good music and love to read books in my spare time. I love non-vegetarian food and don't mind having it 24x7.

One of the little known secrets of my life is that I always wanted to be an interior designer!

Today, I think, dream and live only tennis. I am proud to lend my face and voice to many welfare projects and enjoy being a brand ambassador.

Activity 3

i) Tennis player from India

ii) First Indian woman to win a WTO tournament (in 2006).

iii) Hardworking
Dedicated
Reflects on her strengths and weaknesses

iv) Music, reading, good food

v) a) he saw her game
b) 18
c) hard work and dedication
d) become an interior designer
e) to win the Wimbledon Single's title.

Activity 4

1) He is a tennis player

2) What are the office timings?

3) Who is the manager of the sales department?

4) Sunil Arora works in the Purchase Department.

5) Who is she?

6) Where is the Director's office?

7) Can I meet the principal today?

II)

1) Do students work hard ———— ?
2) Did they play ———— ?
3) Is the Amazon the largest ———— ?
4) Can a horse run ————————?
5) Is the lion the king ———— ?
6) Did Hitler hate———————— ?
7) Did I send ———————— ?
8) Do they work ———— ?
9) Does my father always help ———— ?
10) Did the baby cry ———————— ?

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